IMPLEMENTATION OF CLIENT SCRIPT AND UI POLICY

PAGE 1 – INTRODUCTION

INTRODUCTION

ServiceNow is a cloud-based platform used by organizations to manage IT services, business processes, incidents, requests, changes, and other operations. ServiceNow provides different configuration tools to customize forms and make applications easier for users.

CLIENT SCRIPTS AND UI POLICIES

Two important features used for form customization are Client Scripts and UI Policies. Both are used on the client side, which means they mainly control how a form behaves in the user's browser.

OBJECTIVES

The main objectives are to understand Client Scripts and UI Policies, learn how to create and configure them, improve form usability, and maintain accurate and complete information in forms.

IMPORTANCE

Client Scripts and UI Policies reduce manual work and help users enter correct information. They can dynamically change the form according to the user's input.

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CLIENT SCRIPT

A Client Script is JavaScript code that runs in the user's browser when a specific form action takes place. Client Scripts are mainly used to control the behavior of fields and forms.

TYPES OF CLIENT SCRIPTS

There are four major types of Client Scripts: onLoad, onChange, onSubmit, and onCellEdit.

onLoad

The onLoad Client Script runs when a form is loaded. It can display a message, set a default value, make a field read-only, or hide a field.

onChange

The onChange Client Script runs when the value of a field changes. For example, changing an incident priority can automatically update another field.

onSubmit

The onSubmit Client Script runs when the user submits the form. It can validate information before the record is submitted.

onCellEdit

The onCellEdit Client Script runs when a user edits a field directly from a list.

ADVANTAGES

Client Scripts provide dynamic form behavior, perform client-side validation, improve user experience, reduce incorrect data entry, automatically update fields, and provide instant feedback.

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CREATING A CLIENT SCRIPT

Log in to ServiceNow and navigate to All → System Definition → Client Scripts. Click New, select the required table, enter a meaningful name, choose the script type, write the required script, and save it.

EXAMPLE OF onChange CLIENT SCRIPT

```
function onChange(control, oldValue, newValue, isLoading, isTemplate) {
if (isLoading) return;
if (newValue == "1") {
alert("High priority has been selected.");
}
}
```

EXPLANATION

The script checks the value of the priority field. If the selected value represents high priority, a message is displayed.

EXAMPLE OF onSubmit CLIENT SCRIPT

```
function onSubmit() {
if (g_form.getValue("short_description") == "") {
alert("Please enter a short description.");
return false;
}
return true;
}
```

EXPLANATION

This script checks whether the Short Description field is empty. If it is empty, the record is not submitted.

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UI POLICY

A UI Policy is a ServiceNow configuration used to dynamically change the behavior of fields on a form. UI Policies can make fields mandatory, read-only, visible, or hidden.

COMPONENTS OF A UI POLICY

A UI Policy mainly contains a Table, Conditions, and Actions. The table identifies where the policy works. Conditions determine when it runs. UI Policy Actions determine what happens to fields.

UI POLICY ACTIONS

Mandatory makes a field compulsory. Visible controls whether a field is displayed. Read-only prevents users from modifying a field.

REVERSE IF FALSE

The Reverse if False option reverses the UI Policy Action when the condition becomes false. For example, a field can become mandatory for a critical incident and optional again when the priority changes.

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CREATING A UI POLICY

Log in to ServiceNow and navigate to All → System UI → UI Policies. Click New, select the required table, enter a meaningful name, set the condition, and save the UI Policy.

EXAMPLE

Create a UI Policy named 'Make Assignment Group Mandatory for Critical Incidents'. Set the table to Incident and the condition to Priority is 1 - Critical.

UI POLICY ACTION

Create a UI Policy Action for the Assignment Group field and set Mandatory = True. When the incident priority is Critical, the Assignment Group field becomes mandatory.

ANOTHER EXAMPLE

If an organization wants the Business Service field to be mandatory whenever an incident has high priority, set the condition to Priority = High and set Business Service → Mandatory = True.

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DIFFERENCE

Client Scripts use JavaScript and are suitable for complex logic. UI Policies are mainly configuration-based and are easier to use for simple field behavior.

Feature	Client Script	UI Policy
Technology	JavaScript	Configuration
Coding	Usually requires scripting	Usually no scripting
Field visibility	Possible	Possible
Mandatory field	Possible	Possible
Read-only field	Possible	Possible
Validation	Strong support	Limited
Complex logic	Suitable	Less suitable

WHEN TO USE CLIENT SCRIPT

Client Scripts are useful when complex logic is required, such as validating multiple fields, performing calculations, comparing field values, showing custom messages, or preventing form submission.

WHEN TO USE UI POLICY

UI Policies are useful when simple field behavior is required, such as making a field mandatory, read-only, hidden, or visible.

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CONCLUSION

Client Scripts and UI Policies are important features in ServiceNow for customizing forms and improving user interaction. A Client Script provides flexibility through JavaScript and can perform validation, calculations, and dynamic changes. A UI Policy provides a simple way to control field behavior based on conditions.

KEY POINTS

Client Scripts run on the client side and use JavaScript. There are four main types of Client Scripts. UI Policies control form field behavior and can make fields mandatory, visible, or read-only. Client Scripts are suitable for complex logic, while UI Policies are suitable for simple field behavior.

FINAL STATEMENT

The proper implementation of Client Scripts and UI Policies helps organizations build efficient and user-friendly ServiceNow applications. They reduce incorrect data entry, improve form behavior, and provide users with a better experience while working with ServiceNow forms.